

TikTok U.S.: reach the data center planning director

Account entry plan for Spencer Refer | Prepared Thursday, October 1, 2026 | Sources: HubSpot, Lemlist, ZoomInfo

94 Data Center intent (Sep 12)	27 TikTok contacts in HubSpot	8+ engineers emailed Sep 30 - Oct 1	0 replies so far
STAGE Prospect. No deal.	RUNNING NOW CTF ENT - Leaders (Bing Ren, Sean Mahon, Saboya Yang, Peter Norris); Practitioners (DC ops and network engineers)	LAST TOUCH Oct 1: Jack Thompson emailed; Sep 30: Nawarathne, Kevin L, Andy Ma, Paolo Portoni	NEXT STEP Mon Oct 5: personal email to Sean Mahon (Data Center Planning and Acquisition Director)

Bottom line

TikTok's US data operation showed **Data Center 94**, Networking/Telecom 81, Digital Realty 72 and network infrastructure intent in September. In Feb-Mar you emailed Regina Chan with no reply. This week the Practitioners campaign hit many data center operations engineers, who run equipment but don't buy fiber. The person who does is **Sean Mahon, Data Center Planning and Acquisition Director**, already in Leaders. Send him a personal email, and stop adding operations staff.

What TikTok US is, in one analogy

We've been talking to the people who stock the shelves. Sean Mahon is the one who picks which warehouse to lease.

Signals worth citing

Signal	Source	So what for the opener
Data Center 94, Net/Telecom 81, DLR 72 (Sep 12)	ZoomInfo intent	Facility research.
Networking Solutions 72 (B), Network Infrastructure 72 (B), Sep 19	ZoomInfo intent	Network build.
Sean Mahon, DC Planning and Acquisition Director	Lemlist	Buyer of sites and connectivity.

Work already in motion

High volume, mostly at the operations level.

When	Channel / campaign	What happened	Read
Feb 24, Mar 3	HubSpot email	Regina Chan	No reply
Sep 30 - Oct 1	CTF ENT - Practitioners	DC operations engineers and network engineers emailed	No reply yet
Sep 30	CTF ENT - Leaders	Bing Ren, Sean Mahon, Saboya Yang, Peter Norris	Sequence

Who to reach, in order

Contact	Title (source)	Where	Why they matter	Status / email
Sean Mahon	Data Center Planning and Acquisition Director (Lemlist)	n/a	Buyer.	Leaders
Saboya Yang	Head of Product Infrastructure (Lemlist)	n/a	Infrastructure sponsor.	Leaders
Kevin L.	Network Engineer (HubSpot)	n/a	Technical.	Emailed Sep 30

Not worth chasing for this goal

Data center operations technicians, the industry activation strategist (Paolo Portoni, marketing) and APAC staff.

How the access path should run

Sean Mahon Site and path question	→	Saboya Yang Sponsor	→	Route review Cermak and Elk Grove	→	Proposal -
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Messages, by contact

1. Sean Mahon Data Center Planning and Acquisition Director

Why them: Picks sites and connectivity.

Channel: Personal email Mon Oct 5 (pause his Leaders step) | Subject: Chicago data center paths for TikTok U.S.

Sean, if Chicago is in your site plans, Crosstown owns underground fiber on-net at Equinix and Digital Realty at 350 E Cermak and Equinix CH3 in Elk Grove, mapped to the conduit. I can show which buildings we link on separate paths. 20 minutes?

The plan

When	Move	Notes
Fri Oct 2	Stop adding DC operations staff; pause Paolo Portoni.	-
Mon Oct 5	Personal email to Sean Mahon.	-
Thu Oct 8	Email Saboya Yang.	-
Week of Oct 19	Goal: site-planning call.	-

What progress looks like (for management)

By	Milestone	How we will know
Oct 16	Reply from Mahon or Yang	Logged
Nov 6	Call held	Meeting logged

Guardrails

- Keep messaging technical and neutral.
- Credits used: ZoomInfo company and signals for 1 company.

Sources

HubSpot email history (Feb-Mar) and contacts; Lemlist CTF ENT campaigns; ZoomInfo intent.